

Megan O'Brien

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Omnicom Media – Associate Director, Primary Research

May 2026-Present

- Partner cross-functionally on thought leadership initiatives with research featured at major industry events including CES, POSSIBLE, and Cannes Lions.
- Own longitudinal trend analyses and craft reports for diverse internal and external stakeholders.
- Act as a strategic research advisor for clients, synthesizing proprietary data, market trends, and macro factors to guide brand strategy and media activation.
- Deliver presentations and keynotes to internal stakeholders and clients.
- Incorporate AI-driven research techniques to optimize both quantitative and qualitative project lifecycles.

Omnicom Media – Manager, Primary Research

Dec. 2023-Apr. 2026

- Led end-to-end quantitative and qualitative research studies including research instrument design, data/vendor management, data visualization and reporting.
- Co-developed and executed thought leadership research with OM's enterprise partners.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with internal teams to align research outcomes with strategic objectives.
- Leveraged proprietary tools to capture cultural trends/insights to weave into report narratives.

Omnicom Media – Senior Analyst, Primary Research

Aug. 2021-Nov. 2023

- Developed and oversaw custom research projects supporting new business, agency thought leadership, segmentation efforts, and current events pulse pieces.
- Designed compelling infographics and reports highlighting key metrics and insights.
- Conducted and synthesized 3P research (Mintel, eMarketer, WARC, Forrester, etc.).

Leger USA (formerly 360MR) – Senior Research Analyst

Jan. 2021-Aug. 2021

- Designed and managed custom research projects for clients including brand health trackers, copy testing, etc.
- Analyzed research findings and created actionable insights through reports and infographics.
- Served as the primary moderator for B2B and B2C research communities: ran polls, discussion boards, and surveys to address key research questions/trends of interest.

Numerator – Research Associate

Nov. 2019-Jan. 2021

- Managed instrument design, sample distribution, and fielding of 100+ research projects.
- Programmed and quality checked surveys: implemented complex logic and ensured positive user experience.
- Analyzed data and employed various research methodologies/analyses including, but not limited to, Van Westendorp, Gabor-Granger, TURF, and Max Diff.

University of Edinburgh – Postgraduate Research Assistant

Apr. 2019-Sep. 2019

- Managed databases in connection with the eMoodie application, an Ecological Momentary Assessment tool.
- Led literature reviews on sampling methodology employed in studies published in academic journals.
- Managed large databases utilizing REDCap and SQL.

Leadership and Creativity Lab at Stony Brook – Research Assistant

Jan. 2015-May 2018

- Led focus groups to investigate the processes by which leaders overcome failures and how these processes impact behavior and improve leadership styles.
- Performed various statistical analyses with SPSS including Multiple Regression, Hayes Mediation analysis, etc.

EDUCATION

University of Edinburgh – Psychology of Mental Health (M.S.)

Sep. 2018-Nov. 2019

Thesis: Exploring the Associations between Self-Compassion, Perfectionism, and Help-Seeking Attitudes.

Stony Brook University – Biology (B.S.), Psychology (B.S.)

Aug. 2014-May 2018

CERTIFICATIONS/ORGANIZATIONS

NYU School of Professional Studies – Certificate in Marketing Optimization and Insight

Jan. 2024

Advertising Research Foundation (ARF) – ARF WIDE Mentor

Nov. 2022-Present

Advertising Research Foundation (ARF) – Young Pros Advisory Board

Nov. 2022-Present

SKILLS

SPSS, Q Analytics, MarketSight, Qualtrics, Forsta, Alchemer, CMIX, SQL, Google/Microsoft Products.